



YOU ARE **16 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

163 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The baby's face is partially obscured by the hand in this 3-D image. Babies at this stage are small enough to fit onto the ultrasound screen, but beyond 20 weeks it is increasingly only possible to see a smaller part of the baby at any one time.

“ Ensuring you drink enough is essential to good pregnancy health, so always carry a bottle of water with you when you go out. ”

Staying hydrated in pregnancy can be a challenge. Because of the hormonal changes taking place, some of the fluid you take in leaks into your body tissues, rather than staying within the bloodstream.

It's difficult to recommend an exact amount of fluid that should be drunk to keep you hydrated, since this depends on many factors, such as the foods you eat (some naturally contain water), your size, the amount you exercise, and the heat and humidity in the environment. Therefore, you need to listen to your own body to determine if you're adequately hydrated. One of the best ways to do this is to look at your urine. If it's clear to light yellow, you're adequately hydrated. If it's bright yellow or orange, you're likely to be dehydrated.

Drinking plenty of water is important. Sometimes, though, if you are nauseous, or just plain tired of drinking water, you may want to try other options for hydration, such as drinking a glass of milk; enjoying a light soup, miso, or broth; or having an unsweetened fruit juice. Remember that caffeinated beverages, such as coffee, tea, and cola are not hydrating; caffeine has a diuretic effect, which means that you will need to urinate more often.

A great way to stay hydrated is to eat fruit. Many fruits are very high in water, especially melons, grapes, and strawberries. This water is absorbed very well in your body because it is partnered with sugar, which helps the water stay in your bloodstream. And, of course, fruit is highly nutritious.

NUTRITIOUS SEEDS

Seeds are a powerhouse of the essential fatty acid ALA (see [The power of omega-3](#)) as well as a source of vitamins and minerals. Pumpkin seeds and flaxseeds contain iron, magnesium, and zinc, and sesame seeds provide calcium. Snack on them, sprinkle them on your cereal, and enjoy tahini (sesame paste) in dips and sauces. All seeds contain vitamin E, which boosts immunity and may protect you against [preeclampsia](#).